

CABBAGES *Brassica oleracea* Capitata Group

Cabbages are usually classified according to when they are harvested, and by planting a number of different varieties you can ensure a year-round supply. Spring and summer cabbages are round or pointed in shape, and need to be eaten soon after picking. Fall and winter cabbages are generally larger in size, with denser heads, and are hardy. They can be stored for months once harvested.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
SOW/PLANT				
HARVEST				

SOWING

Dig in well-rotted manure or compost in the fall before planting, and add some lime to the soil in winter if its pH is less than 6.8. Most importantly, the soil needs to be firm, since some cabbages will grow very heavy and their roots will need to support their weight. Ensure that you have a crop rotation system in place, since cabbages should not be planted where brassicas have been grown within the last three years.

Although summer and winter cabbages need to be sowed at different times of year, the method is still the same. Sow in pots or modules at a depth of .75 in (2 cm). Sow summer, fall, and red cabbages in early spring.



Thin seedlings to give them room to grow.

Sow winter cabbages in mid- to late spring, and sow spring cabbages in summer, ready for harvesting the following year.

PLANTING OUT

Plant out your seedlings when they have four true leaves. Plant in rows 16–24 in (40–60 cm) apart, with 12–18 in (30–45 cm) between plants. Dig holes about 6 in (15 cm) deep, and water before gently